

MenuMacros

A restaurant macro finder for the US: full calories and protein for every big chain menu, and the best order for what you have left today. Everything about the app, in one document.

\$920K

est. monthly revenue of the leading app in this niche (MenuFit), about a year after launch

+214%

growth in US Google searches for "high protein fast food" over four years

12 weeks

to build solo; launch on Monday 4 January 2027

"MenuMacros" is a working name. Revenue and download figures are Appfigures estimates (September 2026, worldwide, iOS + Google Play unless stated) and are labelled as estimates throughout. Search figures are from Google Trends. Industry benchmarks are from RevenueCat, AppTweak and others, listed in Sources. Nothing here is financial or legal advice.

Contents

1	The app in one page	What it is, who it's for, why it wins
2	The problem	Why eating out breaks people's tracking
3	Who it's for	Three users, in detail
4	Why now: the evidence	Money, demand and timing
5	The competition	MenuFit in depth, the others, and how to win
6	How the app works	The user's journey, with screen mockups
7	Every screen, explained	Purpose, contents, actions and edge cases
8	Features and what ships when	Version 1, 1.1 and later; free vs Pro
9	How "Best for you" picks orders	The ranking rules, step by step
10	The data	Where numbers come from, the data model, quality checks
11	Technology	Architecture, stack, privacy, offline
12	Money: pricing, trial and payroll	Exact prices and rules
13	Onboarding script	The exact words on each first-run screen
14	App Store page	Name, subtitle, keywords, description, screenshots
15	Marketing plan	\$100/month, faceless, launch calendar
16	Ten faceless video scripts	Shot by shot
17	Build plan	Week by week for 12 weeks
18	Costs and revenue math	Running costs and three scenarios
19	Numbers to track	Weekly dashboard and targets
20	Risks, legal and Apple's rules	What could go wrong and what to do
21	After launch: the roadmap	Months 1 to 12
22	First steps this week	A checklist
23	Glossary	Every term in plain English
24	Sources	Where each fact comes from

1 The app in one page

MenuMacros is an iPhone app for people in the US who count calories or protein and eat at chain restaurants. You open it, pick the restaurant you're at (or one nearby), and immediately see the full calories, protein, carbs and fat for every item on the menu. Pro users also get the five best orders for their goal, ranked for what they have left to eat today, and an order builder that adds up a customised meal as they tap.

What it does

- Shows full nutrition for every item at 50 popular US chains, free.
- Ranks the best orders for your goal (lose weight, maintain, build muscle, or a GLP-1 medication).
- Builds custom orders ("double chicken, no sour cream") with live totals.
- Logs meals to Apple Health and creates a shareable order card.
- Shows the source and the date checked for every chain's numbers.

Who it's for

- **Protein-focused gym-goers** who eat out several times a week.
- **Dieters on a calorie budget** (for example 1,500 a day).
- **GLP-1 users** who eat smaller meals but need protein. 12% of US adults currently take a GLP-1 drug (KFF, Nov 2025).

Where

United States only at launch. iPhone first; Android only once the iPhone app pays.

Why this app, in four facts

1. **People already pay for it.** MenuFit makes an estimated \$920K a month on 330K downloads (Appfigures), about a year after launch.
2. **The leader just stumbled.** 174 of MenuFit's 235 most recent App Store reviews were 1 to 3 stars; many are paying users angry that an update hid calories and macros.
3. **No strong second player.** The next apps for "fast food calories" have 19 and 329 App Store ratings. Appfigures rates the keyword 53 out of 100 for competitiveness.
4. **Demand is rising.** US Google searches for "high protein fast food" are up 214% in four years; US YouTube searches for "healthy fast food" are up 246%.

Item	Decision
Working name	MenuMacros (check availability before committing)
Price	Free to browse all menus; Pro at \$6.99 a month or \$34.99 a year, with a 7-day free trial
How it's different	Only official chain nutrition numbers, with the source shown; full macros always free; 4-screen setup; GLP-1 mode
Build	About 12 weeks solo, using standard Apple tools (SwiftUI); no server code at launch
Launch	Monday 4 January 2027, the start of New Year resolution season
Marketing	One faceless short video a day (TikTok, Reels, Shorts) from 1 December; \$100 a month maximum
Running cost	About \$110 a month including the \$100 marketing budget

2 The problem

People who track what they eat do well at home and fall apart at restaurants. The information exists, but it is buried, incomplete at the counter, and impossible to add up in your head.

What happens today

1. **The menu board shows calories at best.** US rules require chains with 20 or more locations to post calories on menus and to provide protein, carbs, fat and other nutrients in writing on request. So protein, the number many people care about most, is usually not on the board.
2. **The full numbers live in PDFs and calculators.** Each chain publishes its nutrition guide differently: a PDF here, a web calculator there. Nobody opens five of them in a drive-thru queue.
3. **Custom orders break the maths.** A burrito bowl is a base plus a protein plus toppings plus sauces. Doubling the meat or dropping the cheese changes every number, and nobody can add that up at the counter.
4. **General calorie apps are slow for this.** They are built for logging after you've eaten, not for choosing before you order.
5. **The one app built for it has broken trust.** MenuFit's latest update hid calories and macros on menus; reviewers report numbers far from the restaurants' own (see section 5).

How common this is

- 36.6% of US adults ate fast food on a given day, and 44.9% of adults aged 20 to 39 (CDC data brief, 2013 to 2016 survey).
- 12% of US adults currently take a GLP-1 drug and 18% have ever taken one (KFF poll, November 2025). Households with a GLP-1 user cut fast-food spending by 8%, which is why chains such as McDonald's are exploring GLP-1 menu options (September 2026).
- Weight-loss and calorie communities are large: r/loseit has 4.2M members, r/Volumeeating 781K, r/1500isplenty 312K and r/fastfood 311K (GummySearch, 2026).

The job the app does

"I'm at (or near) a restaurant. Tell me, in ten seconds, what I can eat that fits my goal, and let me tweak it." Everything in the app serves that one sentence.

3 Who it's for

Three kinds of people, with different goals but the same question at the counter. The app has one design that serves all three, plus a mode switch for GLP-1 users.

1. The protein-focused gym-goer

Who	Trains 3 to 6 times a week; tracks protein daily; eats out 3 to 5 times a week, often at fast-casual chains.
Goal	Hit a daily protein target without blowing calories.
Today	Googles "highest protein order at [chain]", screenshots TikTok lists, guesses at custom orders.
Wants from the app	The top orders by protein per calorie; doubling protein in the builder; saved go-to orders.
Why they pay	The order builder and ranked picks save time every week.

2. The dieter on a calorie budget

Who	Losing weight on a fixed daily budget (for example 1,500 to 1,800 calories); eats out with family, colleagues or on the road.
Goal	Eat out without guilt or guesswork; stay under the day's budget.
Today	Avoids restaurants, or orders a salad that turns out to be high in calories once dressing is counted.
Wants from the app	"What fits in my remaining 600 calories here?"; swaps that cut calories; logging to Apple Health.
Why they pay	Picks that respect the remaining budget, and the day planner (version 1.1).

3. The GLP-1 user

Who	Taking a GLP-1 medication (for example for weight loss); smaller appetite; often told to prioritise protein.
Goal	Small meals that are still protein-dense.
Today	Finds normal portions too big; orders kids' meals or sides; unsure what gives the most protein in a small portion.
Wants from the app	A GLP-1 mode that caps portion size and ranks by protein; half-portion and side-dish ideas.
Why they pay	Nothing else in this niche is built for them; MenuFit's listing doesn't mention GLP-1.

The app never gives medical advice. GLP-1 mode is described only as "smaller, protein-first orders" (see section 20).

4 Why now: the evidence

Four kinds of evidence point the same way: people already pay for this, interest is growing fast, the market leader is weakening, and the restaurant industry itself is moving towards protein and smaller portions.

People already pay (Appfigures estimates, September 2026)

App	Est. revenue / month	Est. downloads / month	Notes
MenuFit	\$920K	330K	iOS + Google Play; 93% of downloads in the US; released about a year ago; #5 by revenue in US iPhone Food & Drink, #11 on Google Play
Seed Oil Scout	\$110K	10K	Healthy-dining finder focused on cooking oils; 94% US
Fastfoodie	not available	not available	"Fast food macros" app released June 2026; 19 App Store ratings
Cheat Day	not available	not available	"Eat out healthy" app from 2018; 329 App Store ratings

Appfigures estimates revenue after store fees. "Not available" means Appfigures was not checked or showed no figure for that app.

Interest is growing (Google Trends, four-year change)



Average interest Oct 2024 to Sep 2025 compared with Oct 2021 to Sep 2022. Recent weeks compared with the same weeks a year earlier: "high protein fast food" +6%, YouTube "healthy fast food" +27%. Rising related searches include "best healthy fast food options" and "low calorie high protein fast food" (both "Breakout", Google's label for a search that grew more than 5,000%). Meanwhile, interest in "macro calculator" is falling, which suggests people want answers ("what do I order?") more than tools to work things out themselves.

The leader is weakening

- In MenuFit's 235 most recent US and UK App Store reviews, 174 were 1 to 3 stars. The main theme: a recent update stopped showing calories and macros on menus, the reason many people paid.
- Other reviewers report MenuFit's calorie counts are 28% to 40% off the restaurants' own numbers. Its listing says it works "even if the menu has no calories or macros listed", which means it estimates some numbers rather than using the chain's published data.
- A third-party teardown counts 34 onboarding steps before a hard paywall (you must start a trial or pay to use it).

The industry is moving your way

- Chipotle launched a High Protein Menu on 23 December 2025.
- McDonald's is exploring menu options for GLP-1 customers (reported 24 September 2026).
- "Best high-protein order at [chain]" posts already go viral: a 470-calorie McDonald's order got 76.7K likes; a 50g-protein Chick-fil-A order was covered by Chowhound in January 2026.

What this adds up to

A large, proven market with one big player that has just damaged its own reputation, and no strong number two. That is the best kind of opening for a solo founder: you don't need to create demand, only to be the trustworthy alternative people are already looking for.

5 The competition

You compete with one large app (MenuFit), a handful of small ones, and general calorie trackers that people use after eating rather than before ordering.

MenuFit in depth

What it is	"Healthiest Restaurant Meals": personalised meal recommendations at restaurants, fast food, dine-in and bars, with macro breakdowns and suggestions to "healthify" a meal (App Store listing).
Money	Est. \$920K a month on 330K downloads (Appfigures, iOS + Google Play, September 2026). In-app purchases listed from \$9.99 to \$48.00; an "Omni Plan" at \$34.99.
Ratings	4.8 stars from 54K ratings on the US App Store, but recent written reviews are mostly negative (174 of 235 were 1 to 3 stars).
Recent changes	Latest version (early October 2026): "Fresh new look and a brand-new Map feature to find the best meal near you". Reviewers say the redesign removed calories and macros from menus.
Strengths	Brand, momentum, large marketing budget, coverage of many restaurant types.
Weaknesses	Trust (estimated numbers, reported errors), the hidden macros, a long onboarding, a hard paywall, no GLP-1 focus in its listing.

The rest of the field

App	What it is	Threat
Fastfoodie	"Fast Food Macros: low calorie high protein hacks"; released June 2026; 19 ratings	Low today; closest in concept, so watch it
Cheat Day	"Eat Out Healthy" food tracker; since 2018; 329 ratings	Low
CalorieCap	"Fast Food Macros"; buys Apple Ads on "fast food calories"	Low to medium
Seed Oil Scout	Healthy-dining finder by cooking oil; est. \$110K a month; reviewers report thin coverage outside big cities and trouble cancelling	Low (different angle)
MyFitnessPal, Cronometer, Cal AI	General calorie trackers; they also buy Apple Ads on "fast food calories"	Medium: huge, but built for logging, not choosing

How MenuMacros wins, point by point

	MenuFit today	MenuMacros
Where numbers come from	Estimates some menus; reviewers report 28% to 40% errors	Only each chain's published nutrition, with the source and the date checked on every chain
Seeing macros	Hidden on menus after the latest update (reviews)	Full macros on every item, always, free
Setup	34 steps before a hard paywall (third-party teardown)	4 screens, every one skippable, no account
Price	\$9.99 to \$48.00 in-app purchases	Free browsing; Pro at \$6.99 a month or \$34.99 a year
Building an order	"Healthify" suggestions	Build-your-own with live totals and one-tap swaps
GLP-1 users	Not mentioned in its listing	A GLP-1 mode: smaller portions, protein first
Coverage	Fast food, dine-in and bars	50 popular chains done carefully first; more later
Sharing	Not checked	A shareable order card on every order

Be honest about the threat

MenuFit is shipping updates and could restore full macros at any time. Your lasting edge cannot be "the feature they removed". It has to be accuracy you can prove (sources on every number), a fair free tier, speed, and features for people MenuFit ignores (GLP-1 users, custom orders).

6 How the app works

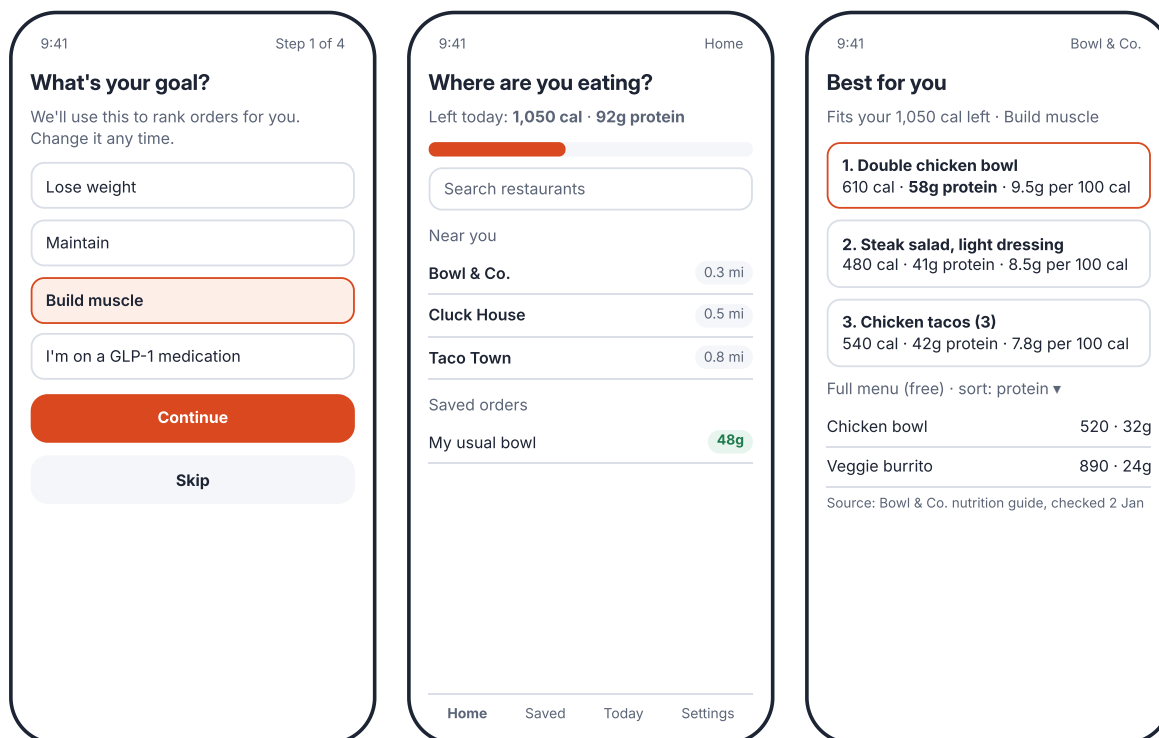
The promise is "open, pick the restaurant, get your order" in under ten seconds. Below is the full journey a new user takes, then mockups of each main screen.

The journey, step by step

1. **Install and open.** No account and no paywall. Four short setup screens, each skippable (exact words in section 13).
2. **Set a goal.** Lose weight, maintain, build muscle, or "I'm on a GLP-1 medication". This changes how orders are ranked.
3. **Set daily targets.** Calories and protein, typed in or suggested from weight, height, age and activity.
4. **Allow location (optional).** Used only on the phone to list chains nearby. Without it, the user searches by name.
5. **Home: "Where are you eating?"** Nearby chains, favourites and search. Today's remaining calories and protein sit at the top.
6. **Chain page.** First, "Best for you": the top 5 orders for the user's goal that fit what's left today (Pro). Below, the full menu with calories, protein, carbs and fat on every item (free), sortable by protein, calories or protein per calorie.
7. **Order builder (Pro).** Tap an item or a "Best for you" pick and customise it: add, remove, double or swap components. Totals update live against the day's budget.
8. **Done.** Save the order, log it to Apple Health (Pro), or share an order card (free). Today's totals update.
9. **Next time.** Saved orders sit on the home screen; one tap to reorder and log.

The paywall appears only when a free user taps something Pro for the first time (usually "Best for you" or the order builder), never at launch. Section 12 has the exact rules.

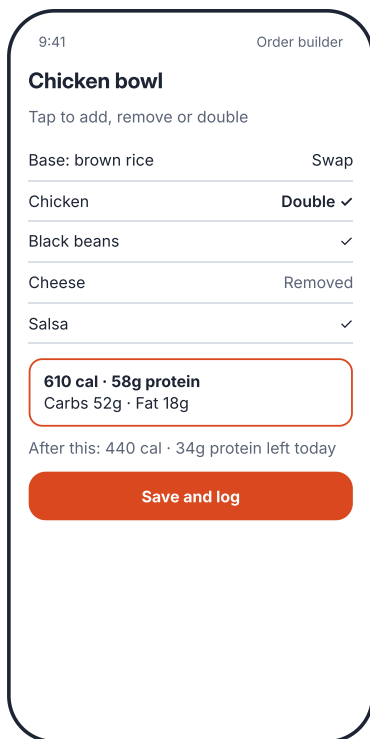
Mockups are layout sketches. Restaurant names and all numbers in them are placeholders, not real nutrition data.



Onboarding: goal
One tap; skippable.

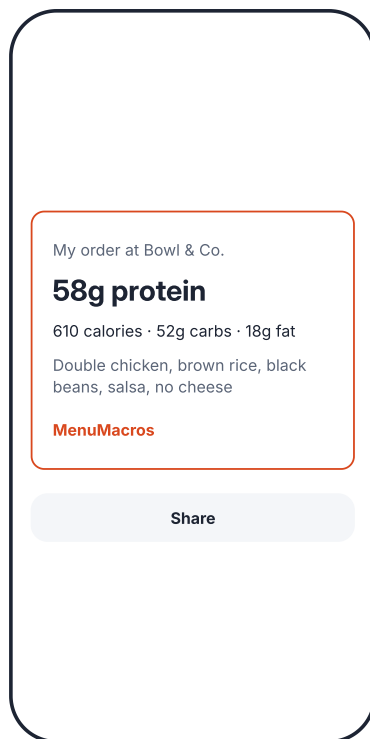
Home
Nearby chains, saved orders, today's budget.

Chain page
Top picks (Pro) above the full free menu.



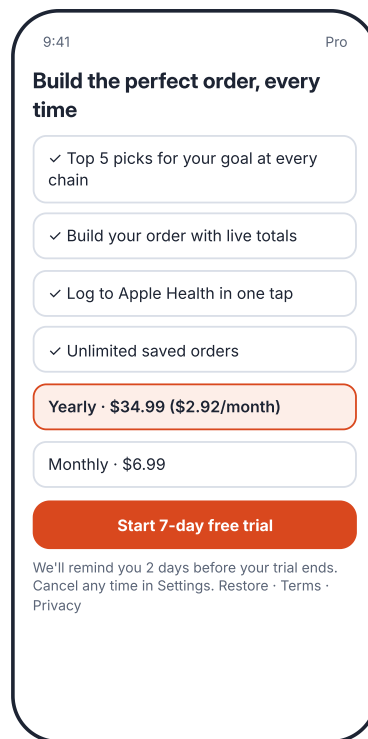
Order builder

Live totals against today's budget.



Share card

Free; every share advertises the app.



Paywall

Shown only at the first Pro tap.

7 Every screen, explained

Ten screens make up version 1. For each: what it's for, what's on it, what the user can do, and what happens when something is missing.

Screen	Purpose	Contents and actions	Edge cases
Onboarding (4)	Set goal and targets, explain location	Goal choice; calorie and protein targets (typed or suggested); location permission explainer; a one-screen "how it works". Every screen has Skip.	Skipped targets: use 2,000 cal and no protein goal until set; the app nudges once on the home screen.
Home	Get to a chain in one tap	Today's remaining calories and protein with a progress bar; search; "Near you" (up to 10 chains, by distance); favourites; saved orders.	No location: hide "Near you" and show popular chains. Offline: everything still works from the stored menus.
Search	Find any chain or item	Type-ahead over chain names and menu items ("chicken wrap" shows matches across chains).	No match: "We don't cover this yet. Request it" (adds a vote to a list you see).
Chain page	Decide what to order	"Best for you" top 5 (Pro); full menu grouped by category with calories, protein, carbs, fat; sort by protein, calories, protein per 100 calories; filters (vegetarian, no pork); source and date checked; favourite button.	Free users see the "Best for you" block blurred with a "Try Pro free" button. Limited-time items carry a "New" tag.
Item detail	See one item fully	All published nutrients (calories, protein, carbs, fat, plus sodium, sugar and fibre where the chain publishes them); serving description; "Customise" (Pro); "Log" (Pro); "Share".	Missing nutrient: shown as "not published", never estimated.
Order builder	Customise and total an order	Components grouped (base, protein, toppings, sauces, sides, drink); add, remove, double, swap; live totals; "After this: X left today"; Save, Log, Share.	Chains without component data: builder works at item level only (add items and sides together).
Saved	Reorder fast	Saved orders by chain; one tap to log again or edit. Free users can save 3.	A saved item removed by the chain: marked "No longer on the menu".
Today	See the day at a glance	Meals logged in the app today, totals vs targets; "Plan dinner" shortcut (version 1.1 day planner).	Apple Health off: totals still kept in the app.
Settings	Control	Goal and targets; GLP-1 mode portion cap; units; Apple Health on/off; subscription status; restore purchases; "How we get our numbers"; contact; privacy.	Cancelling Pro keeps all saved orders; Pro features lock again.
Report a number	Keep data right	From any item: "This looks wrong" with a field for the correct value and optional photo of the in-store board.	Reports go to your fix queue; the user gets a "Thanks, we'll check within 48 hours" message.

Design rules

- Numbers are the hero: large, aligned, the same order everywhere (calories, protein, carbs, fat).
- One accent colour for "fits your goal"; no traffic-light judgements on food.
- Every screen readable one-handed in a queue; tap targets at least 44 points (Apple's guidance).
- Supports Dynamic Type (large text) and Dark Mode from version 1.
- No restaurant logos (see section 20); names in plain text.

8 Features and what ships when

Version 1 does one job very well for the chains people visit most. Everything else waits until users ask for it, so you launch in January instead of spring.

Feature	Version	Free or Pro	Why it's there
Full menus with calories, protein, carbs and fat for 50 popular US chains	1	Free	The thing MenuFit hid; wins reviews and search traffic
Source and "last checked" date on every chain	1	Free	Trust: answers "your numbers are wrong" before it's said
Goals and daily targets, including GLP-1 mode	1	Free	Needed to rank orders and show what's left today
Nearby chains (Apple Maps) and search	1	Free	Speed at the counter
Sort and filter menus (protein, calories, protein per calorie; vegetarian, no pork)	1	Free	Useful without paying, so people keep the app
Shareable order card	1	Free	Built-in word of mouth
Saved orders	1	3 free Pro: unlimited	Habit; a natural reason to upgrade
"Best for you": the top 5 orders per chain for your goal and remaining budget	1	Pro	The core paid value
Order builder with live totals and swaps	1	Pro	What people can't do in their heads
Log to Apple Health	1	Pro	Fits people who already track elsewhere
"Report a number"	1	Free	Your early-warning system for data errors
Home-screen widget (calories and protein left today)	1.1	Pro	Daily reminder of the app
Siri and Shortcuts ("What should I get at Taco Bell?")	1.1	Pro	Hands-free in the car
Day planner ("lunch at one chain, dinner at another")	1.1	Pro	Dieters plan ahead
Search beyond the first 50 (FatSecret database)	1.1	Pro	Breadth after accuracy
100 chains	1.2	Both	Coverage people request most (from "Request it" votes)
Apple Watch glance	1.2	Pro	Nice to have
Barcode scan for gas-station and convenience-store food	1.3	Pro	Road trips; FatSecret Premier Free includes barcode data
Android	Later	Both	Only once the iPhone app pays; MenuFit earns on Google Play too
Estimating menus from a photo	Not planned	—	Estimating unlisted menus is a likely source of MenuFit's accuracy complaints

Features deliberately left out of version 1

- **Accounts and logins:** not needed; everything is stored on the phone. Add iCloud sync later if people ask.
- **Full food diary:** MyFitnessPal and Apple Health already do this; you log into Apple Health instead.
- **Allergy filtering:** too risky to get wrong in version 1. Show the chain's own allergen guide link instead.
- **Social feed, streaks, badges:** distractions from the one job.

9 How "Best for you" picks orders

"Best for you" is the feature people pay for, so its rules must be simple, predictable and explainable in one line under each pick. Here is the full logic. The default numbers are starting points to tune with real users.

Inputs

- **Goal:** lose, maintain, build muscle, or GLP-1.
- **What's left today:** daily calorie and protein targets minus anything logged today.
- **Meal budget:** how much of what's left this meal may use. Default: breakfast 25%, lunch 35%, dinner 40% of the daily calorie target, but never more than what's left. In GLP-1 mode, a user-set "comfortable meal size" (default 450 calories) caps it.
- **Preferences:** vegetarian, no pork, no beef (from item tags you enter; not for allergies).

Steps

1. **Collect candidates.** Every standard menu item, plus pre-built combinations for build-your-own chains (for example, each protein with each base and the most common toppings). Pre-build up to 200 combinations per chain in your data pipeline, so the phone only sorts a list.
2. **Remove what doesn't fit.** Over the meal budget; against preferences; items marked unavailable.
3. **Score.** Main score: grams of protein per 100 calories. Lose and GLP-1 goals also add a small bonus for being further under budget; build muscle adds a bonus for total protein (so a 60g meal beats a 20g snack with the same ratio).
4. **Break ties.** Closer to the meal budget wins; then fewer items; then the chain's own name order.
5. **Show the top 5,** each with one line of reasoning: "58g protein · 610 cal · 9.5g per 100 cal". Tapping a pick opens it in the order builder, ready to tweak.

GLP-1 mode differences

- Meal cap set by the user (default 450 calories); sides and smaller portions included as candidates.
- Picks with at least 25g of protein shown first when any exist.
- Copy is neutral: "smaller, protein-first orders". No medical claims.

Worked example (placeholder numbers)

A user building muscle has 1,050 calories and 92g of protein left; it's lunch, so the meal budget is 35% of a 2,400 target, 840 calories. At a bowl chain, a "double chicken bowl" (610 cal, 58g) scores 9.5g per 100 calories plus a total-protein bonus and ranks first. A "veggie burrito" (890 cal) is removed for being over budget.

Numbers are illustrative only.

What it never does

- Never ranks using estimated numbers; only published chain data.
- Never hides why something ranked where it did.
- Never labels food as "good" or "bad".

10 The data

The data is the hard part and the moat. A large app chasing breadth finds careful, sourced data for the top chains hard to match; that is where you win.

Where the numbers come from

1. **Chains' own nutrition guides (primary)**. FDA menu-labelling rules (in force since 7 May 2018) require chains with 20 or more US locations to post calories on menus and to provide other nutrition information, including protein, carbs and fat, in writing on request. Most big chains publish full guides or calculators online. You enter each item and each customisable component from these.
2. **FatSecret Platform API (backup and long tail)**. The Premier Free edition is free for startups with under \$1M revenue and under \$1M raised: unlimited calls, the US dataset, caching allowed, barcode and allergen data included, attribution required. The Basic edition (5,000 calls a day) does not allow caching. Confirm its restaurant coverage when you sign up.
3. **Edamam (paid fallback)**. From \$14 a month for 100K calls; attribution required.

How the data is stored

Record	Fields
Chain	id, name, cuisine, nutrition source title and URL, date last checked, data version
Menu item	id, chain, name, menu category, serving description, calories, protein (g), carbs (g), fat (g), plus sodium (mg), sugar (g) and fibre (g) when published; tags (vegetarian, contains pork, contains beef); limited-time flag; date added
Component	For build-your-own chains: id, chain, group (base, protein, topping, sauce, side, drink), name, portion, the same nutrient fields; which components a standard item includes
Option	A change to an item: remove, add, double or swap a component, with the nutrient change it causes
Combination	Pre-built orders for "Best for you": list of components and the totals
Report	Item, reported value, note, optional photo, date, status (open, fixed, rejected)

The data routine

1. **Enter**: one spreadsheet tab per chain, typed from the chain's guide.
2. **Check**: a script flags any item where calories differ from $(4 \times \text{protein} + 4 \times \text{carbs} + 9 \times \text{fat})$ by more than 15%. This standard energy check catches most typing mistakes. Spot-check 10% of items against the source by eye.
3. **Build**: the script turns the sheets into one JSON file per chain plus a small "manifest" listing versions.
4. **Publish**: upload to a static host. The app checks the manifest at launch and downloads only changed chains.
5. **Maintain**: every week, check the top 20 chains for new or limited-time items; every month, re-check every chain's guide date; fix any reported number within 48 hours.

Which chains first

Fifty chains at launch, chosen by how often your target users eat there and whether they have a build-your-own format (where the order builder shines). Examples to include: McDonald's, Chick-fil-A, Taco Bell, Chipotle, Subway, Starbucks, Wendy's, Burger King, Panera, Panda Express, Cava, Sweetgreen, Jersey Mike's, Raising Cane's, Popeyes, KFC, Dunkin', Five Guys, Wingstop, Qdoba. Let the "Request it" votes decide chains 51 to 100.

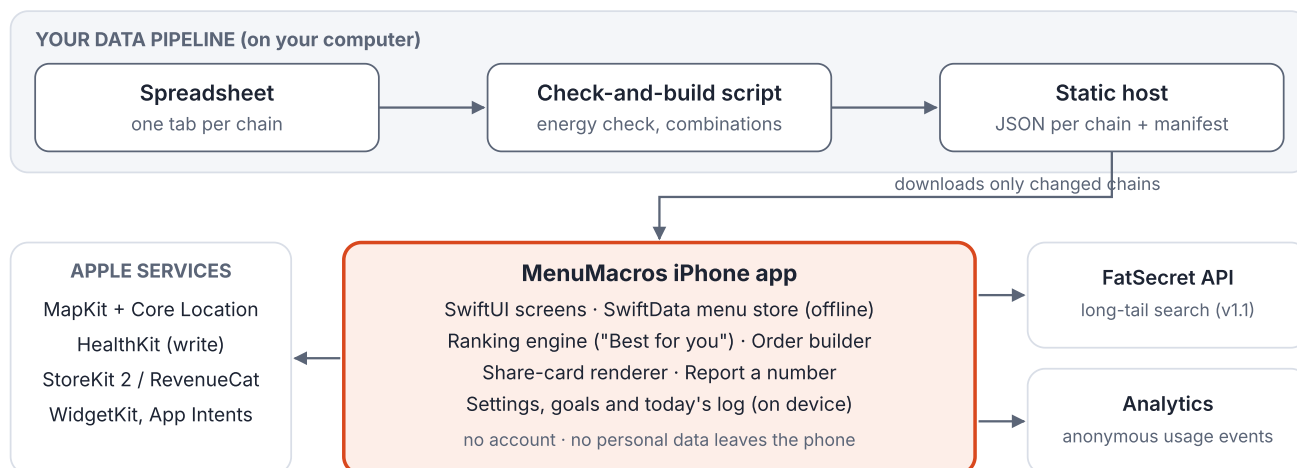
Time it takes (my estimate)

About 2 to 3 hours per chain to enter and check a full menu; build-your-own chains take longer because of components. Fifty chains is roughly 100 to 150 hours, which is why data entry starts in week 1 and runs in parallel with coding.

11 Technology

Standard Apple tools, no server code at launch, and everything stored on the phone. That keeps the build to 12 weeks and running costs near zero.

Menu data flows one way: from your spreadsheet to every phone



The stack

Part	Choice	Why
Language and UI	Swift, SwiftUI, iOS 17 or later	Fastest way for one person to build a polished iPhone app
On-phone storage	SwiftData	Menus load instantly and work offline
Menu delivery	JSON files on a static host (for example Cloudflare R2 or GitHub Pages)	No server to run; cheap or free
Location	Core Location + MapKit local search	Finds nearby chain locations without a paid maps service
Health	HealthKit: write calories, protein, carbs, fat	Users' existing trackers see the meal
Payments	StoreKit 2, or RevenueCat on top	RevenueCat makes paywall tests and revenue charts easy
Widgets and Siri	WidgetKit, App Intents	Version 1.1 features with little code
Analytics	A privacy-friendly tool (for example TelemetryDeck)	Counts events without personal data
Crash reports	Xcode Organizer (built in)	Free
Notifications	Local notifications only	The trial reminder needs no server

Privacy (and the App Store privacy label)

- No account, no name, no email required. Goals, targets, saved orders and today's log stay on the phone.
- Location is used on the phone only, to sort nearby chains; it is never stored or sent anywhere.
- Health data is written to Apple Health only when the user taps Log; it is never read for advertising or shared. Apple's rules forbid using HealthKit data for advertising.
- Analytics are anonymous counts (for example "order builder opened"). Purchase status comes from Apple.

12 Money: pricing, trial and paywall

Let people see real value before asking for money, then ask clearly and honestly. Competitor reviews in this niche punish the opposite: forced trials, surprise charges and hard-to-find cancellation.

Plan	What's included	Price
Free	Every chain's full menu with macros; goals and targets; GLP-1 mode setting; sort and filter; search and nearby; 3 saved orders; share cards; report a number	\$0
Pro yearly	Everything in Free, plus "Best for you", the order builder, unlimited saved orders, Apple Health logging; later the widget, Siri and day planner	\$34.99 / year
Pro monthly	The same as yearly	\$6.99 / month
Lifetime (test later)	Pro forever; test only once you know how long people stay	\$59.99 once

For comparison: RevenueCat's 2026 medians for Health & Fitness apps are \$9.99 a month and \$39.94 a year; MenuFit lists purchases from \$9.99 to \$48.00. MenuMacros sits just under the market.

Paywall rules

1. **Never at launch.** The first time a free user taps "Best for you", the order builder or Log, show the paywall. Closing it returns them to what they were doing.
2. **Trial:** 7 days free on the yearly plan, offered on the paywall. The reminder is a local notification 2 days before billing, exactly as promised on the screen.
3. **Clear price:** the price after the trial is shown in the same size as the trial offer; no hidden "continue" traps.
4. **One more chance:** if someone dismisses the paywall three times, show a one-time offer of the first year at \$24.99 (test it; drop it if it doesn't help).
5. **Easy cancel:** a "Manage subscription" link in Settings opens Apple's subscription page.

Why these choices

- RevenueCat's 2026 data shows apps with hard paywalls convert far better (10.7% vs 2.1% by day 35), but your niche's reviews show hard paywalls cause anger and 1-star reviews. The compromise: a genuinely useful free tier plus a paywall at the moment of value.
- 55% of 3-day-trial cancellations happen on day 0, and trials of 17 to 32 days convert better (42.5%) than trials under 4 days (25.5%). Start at 7 days; test 14 days later.
- Apple keeps 15% of each sale under its Small Business Program (for developers earning under \$1M a year), so \$34.99 a year leaves you \$29.74 per subscriber.

When to ask for a review

After the user's third saved, logged or shared order, never during setup. Apple shows its rating prompt at most three times in 365 days, so spend those moments when someone has just had a good experience.

13 Onboarding script

Four screens, about 20 seconds, every one skippable. These are the exact words to use. Note that the third-party teardown of MenuFit counts 34 steps.

#	Title	Body, options and buttons
1	What's your goal?	"We'll use this to rank orders for you. Change it any time." Options: <i>Lose weight</i> · <i>Maintain</i> · <i>Build muscle</i> · <i>I'm on a GLP-1 medication</i> . Buttons: Continue · Skip
2	Your daily targets	Calories [field] · Protein [field] g. Link: "Not sure? Suggest targets for me" opens weight, height, age, sex and activity, and suggests calories with the Mifflin-St Jeor formula and protein of 1.2 to 1.6 g per kg of body weight, with a note: "Suggested starting points, not medical advice. Adjust any time." GLP-1 users also see: "Comfortable meal size: 450 calories" (editable). Buttons: Continue · Skip
3	Find restaurants near you	"We use your location only on this phone, to list the chains nearest you. It's never stored or shared." Buttons: Allow location · Not now
4	Here's how it works	Three lines with small icons: "Pick a restaurant" · "See every item's calories and protein" · "Build the order that fits your day". Button: Start

Rules

- No account, no email capture, no quiz beyond these four screens, no paywall, no review prompt.
- If targets are skipped, the home screen shows one gentle card: "Set your targets to see what's left today" (dismissible).
- Protein guidance: the International Society of Sports Nutrition suggests 1.4 to 2.0 g per kg a day for people who exercise; keep the app's default inside common ranges and always editable.

14 App Store page

The store page has two jobs: rank for low-competition searches and turn visitors into downloads in about seven seconds. Here is the exact copy.

Field (Apple's limit)	Text
App name (30)	MenuMacros: Fast Food Macros (28 characters)
Subtitle (30)	High protein restaurant orders (30 characters)
Keyword field (100)	calories,nutrition,healthy,eating,out,diet,glp1,calorie,counter,menu,lowcarb,keto,lunch,drivethru (97 characters; words already in the name and subtitle aren't repeated)
Category	Primary: Health & Fitness. Secondary: Food & Drink
Promotional text (170; doesn't affect search)	"Full calories and protein for every item at 50 popular chains, free. New: GLP-1 mode for smaller, protein-first orders."

Don't put restaurant names in the keyword field

Apple's App Review Guidelines (2.3.7) say not to pack metadata with trademarked terms or other apps' names. Chain names belong inside the app (fully searchable there) and in your videos, not in your keyword field, title or subtitle.

Searches to target

- "fast food calories": Appfigures popularity 5, competitiveness 53/100, the easiest of the keywords checked. Today's advertisers there: MyFitnessPal, MenuFit, Cronometer, Cal AI, CalorieCap.
- "high protein fast food", "healthy eating out", "restaurant nutrition", "eating out calories", "glp1 diet".

Description (draft)

Eating out shouldn't wreck your goals. MenuMacros shows the full calories, protein, carbs and fat for every item at 50 popular US restaurant chains, free, straight from each chain's published nutrition information, with the source shown.

Pick a restaurant, get your order. Choose a chain nearby or search, then see every item's numbers, sorted the way you want: most protein, fewest calories, or most protein per calorie.

Go Pro for the perfect order. Get the top 5 orders for your goal that fit what you have left today. Build your own order (double chicken, no cheese) and watch the totals update as you tap. Log it to Apple Health in one tap.

Made for every goal. Losing weight, maintaining, building muscle, or eating smaller meals on a GLP-1 medication: set your goal once and every recommendation adapts.

Honest by design. No account. No estimates passed off as facts. Spot a number that looks wrong? Tap "Report a number" and we'll check it within 48 hours. MenuMacros is not affiliated with any restaurant and does not give medical advice.

Screenshots (first three show in search results)

- "Full macros for every item. Free." (a chain menu with numbers)
- "Build your order. Watch the protein add up." (the order builder)
- "The 5 best orders for your goal" (Best for you)
- "GLP-1 mode: smaller, protein-first orders"
- "Every number from the chain's own guide" (source line close-up)

Use your own app screens; never use restaurant logos or food photography you don't own.

15 Marketing plan

With \$100 a month, content has to do the work. The plan: one faceless short video every day from 1 December, cross-posted to TikTok, Instagram Reels and YouTube Shorts; a store page built for low-competition searches; and small paid tests only once you know which message works.

Positioning

"Full macros for every chain menu, and the best order for what you have left today. Every number straight from the restaurant." Lead with honesty and speed. Never attack MenuFit by name in ads; let people compare.

What the research says works (and what it costs)

- **Post often.** Buffer's study of 11.4M TikTok posts: posting 2 to 5 times a week got 17% more views per post than once a week; 11 or more times got 34% more.
- **Slideshows work for apps.** One founder's 6-slide TikTok slideshows got 500K+ views in 5 days and 108 paying subscribers. The winning hook was "someone doubted it, I showed them, they changed their mind"; posts about himself got under 3K views.
- **Video vs slideshow is unsettled.** Fanpage Karma found TikTok carousels get 81% more interactions than videos; Buffer's 2026 data shows videos ahead. Test both.
- **Screen recordings convert.** The screen-time app one sec grew from one screen-recording post; 38% of Opal's Meta ads are screen recordings.
- **Skip "link in bio".** Growth advisers recommend "Top 5 apps for X" list videos that include competitors.
- **Apple Ads costs.** Average US cost per install \$4.06 (\$3.77 in Health & Fitness); UK \$2.60 (AppTweak, 2025). \$100 buys roughly 25 to 40 installs: enough to test keywords, not to grow.
- **Small creators.** TikTok creators with 500 to 10K followers charge roughly \$5 to \$50 a post (a directional figure); entry-level UGC videos cost \$50 to \$100.

Channels, in priority order

Channel	What to do	Effort
TikTok, Reels, Shorts	One video a day, same video on all three. Formats: 6-slide slideshows, screen recordings of the app, split-screen swaps. Numbers come from your own database.	45 to 60 min a day
App Store search	The store page in section 14; add chains in updates and mention them in "What's New".	2 hours a month
Reddit	r/1500isplenty (312K), r/Volumeeating (781K), r/fastfood (311K), r/loseit (4.2M), r/Zepbound (237K). Share genuinely useful order lists as text; read each subreddit's self-promotion rules; mention the app only where allowed or when asked.	2 posts a week
Share cards	Every shared order card carries the app name. Encourage sharing with a "Share your order" button after saving.	Built into the app
Nano creators	From month 2: 2 to 3 creators who already post fast-food order content, each making one video from your best hook.	Outreach 1 hour a week
Apple Ads Basic	From month 3: about \$50 on "fast food calories" and related generic terms; pay per install.	30 min a month

The \$100 a month, month by month

Month	Spend	Goal
December 2026	\$0	Daily videos; find the 3 best hooks; collect TestFlight testers from bio
January 2027 (launch)	\$0	Re-post the best hooks with the app live; Reddit launch posts; first reviews
February	About \$50 creators + \$50 held	Test whether creators beat your own videos
March	About \$50 creators + \$50 Apple Ads	Learn which keywords convert
From April	Put the \$100 where installs were cheapest	Repeat what worked

Launch calendar

When	What
1 December 2026	Start daily videos (pre-launch); "follow for the app launch"
Mid-December	TestFlight beta; submit to Apple
Monday 4 January 2027	Launch: re-post best 7 hooks over the week; Reddit posts; email testers
January to March	New Year goals; US YouTube searches for "healthy fast food" peak in February
Any new menu item	Same-day video: "Is the new [item] worth the calories?"
June	Summer road-trip push; US searches for "high protein fast food" peak in June

Creator outreach message (template)

"Hi [name], I love your [chain] order videos. I've built MenuMacros, an app that shows full macros for 50 chains and builds the highest-protein order for any calorie budget. Would you make one video using it, in your usual style? I can pay \$[20 to 40] and give you free Pro for life. No script needed; I'd just love an honest take."

16 Ten faceless video scripts

Each needs only screen recordings, slides or your hands; a text-to-speech voiceover is optional. Fill every number from your own database, and double-check it before posting. Make 2 to 3 versions of each hook and keep the winner.

1. "The highest-protein order at [chain] under 600 calories"

Format: screen recording, 15 to 20 seconds. **Shots:** open app → pick chain → "Best for you" → tap #1 → order builder adds double protein → total appears big.

On screen: hook text (2 sec) → "[X]g protein · [Y] cal" → "Save this for next time". **Why:** US searches for "high protein fast food" up 214% in 4 years.

2. "I ranked every [chain] item by protein per calorie"

Format: 6-slide slideshow. **Slides:** 1 hook; 2 to 4 the top 5 with numbers; 5 the worst 3; 6 "Full list free in the app".

Why: ranking slideshows are the format behind the 500K-view case study.

3. "This 'healthy' salad has more calories than a [burger]"

Format: slideshow, side-by-side macro cards. **Rule:** only use a pair where your data truly shows it. **Why:** myth-busting gets comments and shares.

4. "My friend said you can't hit 150g of protein eating out. So I showed him."

Format: slideshow: breakfast, lunch, dinner at three chains, a running protein total, a final slide with the day's totals. **Why:** the "doubt → showed them" hook won in the slideshow case study.

5. "GLP-1 friendly orders: small portion, 30g+ protein"

Format: slideshow, one order per chain at five chains. **Caption:** "Not medical advice; check with your doctor." **Why:** 12% of US adults take a GLP-1 drug; McDonald's is exploring GLP-1 menu options.

6. "Build a 50g-protein [chain] order with me"

Format: screen recording of the order builder: each tap adds protein until it hits 50g. **Why:** a 50g-protein Chick-fil-A order made news in January 2026.

7. "Best protein at every drive-thru on a 1,500-calorie day"

Format: slideshow, one card per chain. **Post in:** also share the list as text on r/1500isplenty (rules permitting). **Why:** 312K members in that community alone.

8. "Swap this for that: same order, half the calories"

Format: split screen, before and after in the order builder. **Why:** YouTube searches for "best healthy fast food options" are a Breakout.

9. "Road trip? The best protein at every [gas-station chain]"

Format: slideshow. **When:** June push. **Why:** "high protein fast food" searches peak in June.

10. "5 apps that show fast-food macros (2026)"

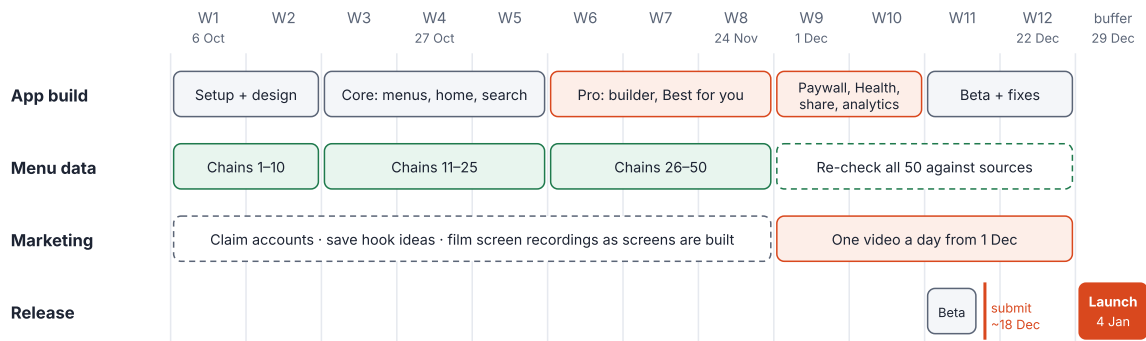
Format: list video of store pages, yours included, with one honest line each. **Why:** the "Top 5 apps for X" tactic growth advisers recommend.

Captions and hashtags

Caption: the hook plus one useful line ("The chicken is double; the rice is half"). Hashtags (3 to 5): #highprotein #fastfood #[chain] #caloriedeficit #macros. Pin a comment: "Every number is from [chain]'s own nutrition guide."

17 Build plan: 12 weeks, week by week

Coding and menu data run side by side from day one; videos start in week 9 so there is an audience on launch day. Assumes about 30 hours a week; with less time, keep the order and stretch the dates.



Week	Dates	Build	Data	Done when
1	6–12 Oct	Enrol in the Apple Developer Program; install Xcode; apply for FatSecret Premier Free; build the data spreadsheet and the check-and-build script	Chains 1–5	Script turns one chain's sheet into JSON and flags energy-check errors
2	13–19 Oct	Sketch all ten screens (Figma free plan); pick colours and type; write the privacy policy and support page	Chains 6–10	Every screen sketched; 10 chains checked
3	20–26 Oct	Xcode project; SwiftData model (section 10); download and store the JSON; the four onboarding screens	Chains 11–15	App installs on your phone, onboards and stores menus
4	27 Oct–2 Nov	Home screen; nearby chains (MapKit); search across chains and items; favourites	Chains 16–20	You can find any chain in two taps
5	3–9 Nov	Chain page with full menu; sort and filter; item detail; works offline	Chains 21–25	Free tier complete (usable as a free app)
6	10–16 Nov	Order builder: components, add, remove, double, swap, live totals	Chains 26–32	A custom bowl totals correctly against the chain's own calculator
7	17–23 Nov	"Best for you" ranking (section 9); GLP-1 mode; pre-built combinations in the script	Chains 33–40	Top 5 picks look sensible at 10 chains you know
8	24–30 Nov	Saved orders; Today screen; Settings; Dynamic Type, Dark Mode and VoiceOver pass	Chains 41–50	All 50 chains in ; every v1 screen works
9	1–7 Dec	Paywall and subscriptions (StoreKit 2 or RevenueCat); free trial; trial reminder notification. Start daily videos.	Weekly menu check	A sandbox purchase unlocks Pro; the reminder fires
10	8–14 Dec	Apple Health logging; share card; "Report a number"; analytics events; review prompt rule	Re-check chains 1–25	Feature complete
11	15–21 Dec	TestFlight with 20 to 50 testers (from your videos); screenshots, store text, privacy label; submit to Apple around 18 December	Re-check chains 26–50	Submitted; tester feedback logged
12	22–28 Dec	Fix tester bugs; resubmit if needed; prepare launch posts and the first week of videos	Final spot check	Approved and set to release manually
Launch	Mon 4 Jan 2027	Release the app; post the best hooks again, now with the app live; Reddit posts where allowed; email TestFlight testers		

29 December to 3 January is a buffer for anything late. Submit early because review times vary over the holidays; once approved, release manually on 4 January. Data: about 2 to 3 hours per chain (section 10), so 5 to 7 chains a week is 10 to 20 hours.

18 Costs and revenue math

Running the app costs about \$110 a month, almost all of it the marketing budget. About four new yearly subscribers a month cover it.

What you need before you start

- A Mac that runs the current version of Xcode (Apple's free tool for building iPhone apps) and an iPhone to test on. If you don't have a Mac, that is the one large up-front cost.
- An Apple Developer Program membership, which you need to put apps on the App Store.

Running costs

Item	Cost	Notes
Apple Developer Program	\$99 a year (about \$8 a month)	Required to publish
FatSecret Platform API, Premier Free	\$0	If you qualify (under \$1M revenue and under \$1M raised); attribution required
Hosting for menu files	\$0 on a free tier	Static files only (for example GitHub Pages or Cloudflare R2)
RevenueCat (optional)	\$0 up to \$2,500 a month in tracked revenue, then 1%	Paywalls, A/B tests and revenue charts
Analytics, design and video tools	\$0 on free plans	For example TelemetryDeck, Figma, CapCut, Canva
Website for privacy policy and support	\$0 (or about \$10 to \$15 a year for your own domain)	Apple requires a privacy policy link
Marketing	Up to \$100 a month	Creators and Apple Ads tests (section 15)
Total	About \$110 a month	

What one subscriber is worth

A yearly plan at \$34.99, minus Apple's 15% (Small Business Program, for developers earning under \$1M a year), leaves **\$29.74**. A monthly plan at \$6.99 leaves \$5.94 a month.

Three scenarios (an illustration, not a forecast)

Downloads a month	New payers a month (2.9%)	Revenue added each month	First year, if steady
Small: 2,000	58	about \$1,700	about \$20,700
Medium: 10,000	290	about \$8,600	about \$103,500
Large: 50,000	1,450	about \$43,100	about \$517,500

How these are worked out

- 2.9% of downloads become paying subscribers: RevenueCat's 2026 median for Health & Fitness apps (a benchmark, not a promise).
- Every payer is assumed to take the yearly plan at \$29.74 after Apple's cut. Monthly plans, renewals in year two, refunds and taxes are left out.
- For scale: MenuFit's estimated 330K downloads in September 2026 (Appfigures estimate) means the "large" case is about 15% of the leader's volume. Its estimated \$920K a month is far above all three cases.
- Break-even: $\$110 \div \29.74 is about 4 new yearly subscribers a month, or about 140 downloads at 2.9%.

19 Numbers to track

Check these every Monday, in a simple spreadsheet. Each number has one place to find it and one thing to do if it is low.

Number	Where	Benchmark or target	If it's low
Downloads, by source (search, browse, web)	App Store Connect	Rising week on week after launch	Look at which source dropped: search means store page and keywords; web means videos
Store page conversion (page views to downloads)	App Store Connect	Your own trend	Test new first three screenshots (Apple's product page tests)
Download to trial	RevenueCat or App Store Connect	6.9% (RevenueCat 2026 median, Health & Fitness)	Paywall shown too rarely or the free tier gives too much; make "Best for you" more visible
Trial to paid	RevenueCat	37.7% (same source). Below 25%: act (my threshold)	Check the trial reminder wording, the onboarding, and whether picks feel useful
Download to paid	RevenueCat	2.9% (same source)	The two numbers above tell you which step is weak
Trials cancelled on day 0	RevenueCat	Lower is better	People feel tricked or confused: make the price and reminder clearer
People who return in week 2	Analytics	Your own trend	Push saved orders and the widget (version 1.1)
Share cards per 100 users	Analytics	Your own trend	Move the Share button; improve the card design
Reports per chain; time to fix	Your fix queue	Every report answered within 48 hours	A chain with many reports: re-check its whole menu
"Request it" votes	Your vote list	—	Add the most-requested chains first
Rating and review count	App Store Connect	4.5 stars or higher	Read every 1 to 3 star review; reply and fix
Video results (views, profile visits, link taps)	TikTok, Instagram, YouTube	Find 3 hooks that beat your average	Change the first 2 seconds before changing the idea

Three checkpoints

- **End of January:** is anyone paying? If trial to paid is below 25%, fix the paywall and picks before spending on marketing.
- **End of March:** which channel brings the cheapest paying users? Put the \$100 there.
- **End of June:** is revenue covering costs and growing? If yes, consider Android and 100+ chains. If not, revisit pricing and the store page before adding features.

20 Risks, legal and Apple's rules

Most risks here are about trust: wrong numbers, unclear billing, or overstated health claims. The plan is built to avoid all three. This is not legal advice; if a restaurant or Apple raises a concern, get proper advice and comply.

Risk	Likelihood	What to do
A number is wrong	High	Only published chain data; energy check on every item; source and date on every chain; "Report a number" with a 48-hour fix. Never estimate a missing value.
Menus change (new and limited-time items)	High	Weekly check of the top 20 chains, monthly check of all; "New" tags; "No longer on the menu" labels on saved orders.
MenuFit fixes its app	Medium	Your edge doesn't depend on its mistakes alone: sources shown, free full macros, GLP-1 mode, short setup, lower price. Keep shipping.
Videos don't take off	Medium	Test 2 to 3 versions of each hook; try slideshows and screen recordings; lean on the store page and Reddit; use small creators from month 2.
Data entry takes longer	Medium	Launch with fewer chains (30 is fine) rather than slipping the date; add the rest in updates.
Apple rejects the app	Low to medium	Follow the rules below; submit by about 18 December so there is time to fix and resubmit.
FatSecret terms change	Low	Version 1 runs on your own data; FatSecret is only for long-tail search in 1.1. Edamam is the paid fallback.
A restaurant objects	Low	Use names in plain text only, show "not affiliated", no logos or photos; respond promptly and remove anything they ask you to.

Restaurant names, logos and data

- Use chain names in plain text only to say whose menu it is. Apple's intellectual-property rules (section 5.2) say not to use others' trademarks without permission, so no logos, brand colours, mascots or food photos you don't own.
- Say clearly, in the app and the store description: "MenuMacros is not affiliated with any restaurant."
- Nutrition values are facts you enter yourself from each chain's published information. Don't copy their PDFs, images or page designs into the app; link to the source instead.

Health claims

- No medical advice and no promises about weight loss. GLP-1 mode is described only as "smaller, protein-first orders".
- Suggested targets are labelled "starting points, not medical advice" and are always editable.
- No allergy filtering in version 1; link to each chain's own allergen guide.

Apple's App Review Guidelines that matter most

Guideline	What it says (in short)	What you do
1.4.1	Medical apps that could give inaccurate data may be reviewed more strictly	No medical claims; sources shown on every chain
2.3.7	Don't pack metadata with trademarked terms or other apps' names; names up to 30 characters	No chain names in the name, subtitle or keyword field
3.1.2	Subscriptions must give ongoing value and clearly state what you get, the price, renewal and how to cancel	Paywall shows price, trial length, renewal and the reminder; "Manage subscription" in Settings
5.1.1(i)	Every app needs a privacy policy, linked in App Store Connect and inside the app	Write it in week 2; link it from Settings
5.1.3	Health data can't be used for advertising or data mining; don't write false data to HealthKit; no personal health data in iCloud	Only write meals the user logs; never use Health data for anything else

FatSecret requires visible attribution wherever its data is shown; add it to search results that use FatSecret in version 1.1.

21 After launch: the roadmap

Ship small updates often, driven by what users ask for and what the numbers say. Each update is also a reason to post a video and to mention new chains in "What's New".

When	Version	What ships	Why
January 2027	1.0.x	Bug fixes; data fixes within 48 hours; reply to every review; add the most-requested chains	Early reviews decide your rating for months
February	1.1	Home-screen widget (calories and protein left today); Siri and Shortcuts; day planner; long-tail search through FatSecret (with attribution). Test a 14-day trial against 7 days.	Daily reminders of the app; planning ahead for dieters; breadth beyond 50 chains
March to April	1.2	100 chains, chosen by "Request it" votes; Apple Watch glance; first Apple Ads tests	Users will ask for more chains; the votes show which
May to June	1.3	Barcode scan for gas-station and convenience-store food (FatSecret Premier Free includes barcode data); road-trip video push; test the \$59.99 lifetime plan	"High protein fast food" searches peak in June
July to September	—	Decide on Android (checkpoint in section 19); iCloud sync if users ask; refresh store screenshots	MenuFit also earns on Google Play (#11 there)
October to December	—	Prepare the New Year 2028 push: new hooks, refreshed store page, holiday menu items	January is the peak season for diet apps

Before thinking about the UK

In England, businesses with 250 or more employees have had to show calories on menus since 6 April 2022 (GOV.UK guidance). Only calories are required; protein, carbs and fat are not. So many UK chains may not publish the full macros the app depends on. Before building a UK version, check how many big UK chains publish full nutrition online.

Also: MenuFit's downloads are 93% US (Appfigures estimate), so the US is where the proven demand is.

Ideas to keep out until the numbers say otherwise

- **Allergy filtering:** only with very careful data and clear warnings; the cost of a mistake is high.
- **Photo-based menu estimates:** the likely cause of MenuFit's accuracy complaints; it would undo your main advantage.
- **Social feeds, streaks and badges:** they don't help someone choose an order faster.
- **Independent restaurants:** US rules only require nutrition information from chains with 20 or more locations, so there is usually nothing reliable to show.

22 First steps this week

Everything here is free except the Apple Developer Program. Tick these off before week 1 of the build plan ends.

The name and accounts

- ☐ Search the App Store, Google and the US trademark database (USPTO, free) for "MenuMacros"; pick a backup name too.
- ☐ Claim the name on TikTok, Instagram and YouTube, even before you post.
- ☐ Enrol in the Apple Developer Program (\$99 a year). You do this yourself in Apple's developer site.
- ☐ Apply for FatSecret Platform's Premier Free edition.
- ☐ Create a free RevenueCat account (optional).

The data

- ☐ Write your list of 50 chains (start from the 20 in section 10).
- ☐ Create the spreadsheet with the fields from section 10.
- ☐ Enter one full chain from its official nutrition page.
- ☐ Run the energy check by hand on 10 items to see how it works.

The app

- ☐ Install Xcode on your Mac.
- ☐ If SwiftUI is new to you, work through Apple's free SwiftUI tutorials.
- ☐ Sketch the home, chain page and order builder on paper or in Figma.
- ☐ Install MenuFit and go through its setup up to the paywall; screenshot each step and note what annoys you. (No need to start a trial.)

The marketing

- ☐ Follow 20 accounts that post fast-food order content; save the hooks that get the most views.
- ☐ Write 20 hook ideas using the ten scripts in section 16.
- ☐ Join the five subreddits in section 15 and read their self-promotion rules.
- ☐ Set up the Monday metrics sheet from section 19.

A weekly rhythm that fits one person

Weekdays	About 4 hours of building and 2 hours of data entry (from December: plus 45 to 60 minutes for one video)
Monday	Check the numbers (section 19); check the top 20 chains for menu changes
Friday	Fix reported numbers; plan next week's videos
Once a month	Re-check every chain's nutrition guide date; review spending

23 Glossary

Every term used in this document, in plain English.

Macros	Short for macronutrients: protein, carbohydrates (carbs) and fat, the three nutrients that provide calories.
Protein per 100 calories	Grams of protein divided by calories, times 100. A simple measure of how protein-dense a food is; the main score behind "Best for you".
Energy check	Protein and carbs give about 4 calories per gram and fat about 9. If $4 \times \text{protein} + 4 \times \text{carbs} + 9 \times \text{fat}$ is far from the listed calories, the entry is probably mistyped.
GLP-1 medication	A group of drugs (for example semaglutide and tirzepatide) used for type 2 diabetes and weight loss. They reduce appetite, so users eat smaller meals.
Chain	A restaurant brand with many locations. US menu-labelling rules apply to chains with 20 or more.
Build-your-own chain	A restaurant where you assemble your meal from parts (base, protein, toppings), such as a burrito-bowl chain.
Limited-time item	A menu item sold for a few weeks only; needs the weekly data check.
Subscription, free trial	Pro is paid monthly or yearly and renews automatically until cancelled. A free trial gives Pro for 7 days before the first charge.
Paywall (hard, soft)	The screen asking people to pay. A hard paywall blocks the app until you pay or start a trial; a soft one (used here) lets people use a free tier.
Conversion rate	The share of people who take the next step, for example downloads that become trials, or trials that become paying users.
Churn, retention	Churn: subscribers who cancel. Retention: users who keep coming back.
App Store Connect	Apple's website for publishing apps, setting prices and seeing downloads and sales.
TestFlight	Apple's free service for sending test versions of your app to up to thousands of testers before launch.
ASO	App Store Optimisation: choosing the name, subtitle, keywords and screenshots so the app ranks in search and visitors download it.
Keyword field	A hidden 100-character field in App Store Connect listing extra search terms, separated by commas.
Keyword popularity, competitiveness	Appfigures scores for how often a term is searched and how hard it is to rank for it.
Apple Ads	Ads shown in App Store search results. Apple Ads Basic charges per install; Advanced charges per tap and gives keyword control.
CPI	Cost per install: what an ad costs for each download it produces.
Appfigures estimate	A modelled guess at an app's downloads or revenue; the real figures are private. Treat as a guide to size, not an exact number.
Google Trends, "Breakout"	Google's tool showing how search interest changes over time (on a 0 to 100 scale, not absolute numbers). "Breakout" means a related search grew more than 5,000%.
Faceless video	A video that never shows your face: screen recordings, slideshows, hands, text on screen and an optional computer voice.
Hook	The first line, slide or two seconds of a video, which decides whether people keep watching.
Nano creator, UGC	A nano creator has a small following (here, about 500 to 10K). UGC (user-generated content) is a video made by a creator in the style of an ordinary user, paid for by a brand.
SwiftUI, SwiftData	Apple's tools for building app screens (SwiftUI) and storing data on the phone (SwiftData).
HealthKit, StoreKit, MapKit	Apple's built-in tools for Apple Health data, in-app purchases and maps.
JSON, static host	JSON is a simple text format for data. A static host serves files as they are, with no server code to run.
Small Business Program	Apple takes 15% of sales (instead of 30%) from developers earning under \$1M a year who enrol.

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